

SINGAPORE BANKS

Deposit growth to buffer or expand ROE, DBS positioned to benefit most

Deposit driven balance sheet expansion can buffer ROE, DBS positioned to benefit most

Singapore banks have experienced robust balance sheet growth, with deposit growth of 4%/ 4%/ 10% yoy for DBS/UOB/OCBC in 1H25, benefiting from the strong deposit and AUM inflows into Singapore, given its status as both a regional wealth hub and a financial safe haven, and its resilient currency. This has become a crucial earnings lever, given subdued loan demand and declining interest rates, as banks use this excess liquidity to deploy into securities and cross-sell in wealth. In this rate cut cycle, this strategy has allowed DBS to achieve 8% yoy growth to NII from securities volume in 1H25, OCBC 6% and UOB 4%. This translates to 4% yoy growth in overall NII for DBS and flat for UOB, while OCBC saw -4% due to weaker loan and deposit repricing.

In this report, we analyze how this strategy contributes to earnings and ROEs. Our analysis shows a 1ppt increase in deposits could add 0.2%–0.4% of operating income from gapping (when deposits are placed in investment securities to earn NII) and 0.6–0.7% of additional operating income if deposits were sourced through AUM. While earnings contribution is low it is highly ROE accretive: for each 1ppt of

deposit growth, we estimate 1–4bps ROE uplift from gapping and 4–8bps uplift from wealth, as ROE from gapping in our analysis is c. 15%–33%, while from wealth it is 30%–60%. Overall we raise our deposit growth by up to 3ppt for 2025 and 2026 for the banks. Among the three Singapore banks, we see DBS as likely to benefit the most given its robust funding franchise allows for stronger than peer ability to gather deposits and at a lower cost, resulting in better earnings and ROE accretion. Overall, we revise our 2025–27E earnings by -2% to +7% for the 3 banks, baking in higher deposit growth, and also adjusting for lower SORA and higher HIBOR.

3Q25 preview: Weaker earnings as rates decline

We expect EPS declines of 4% qoq, and ROE to taper to 13.2% on average for the upcoming 3Q financials, mainly due to a: **1) Sharp decline in NIMs in 3Q of -10 to -11bps qoq**, reflecting continued falls in SORA; **2) Higher qoq credit cost**, as banks remain conservative on provisions, with offsets from; **3) Higher qoq non-NII** mainly due to robust wealth management fees; and **4) well-controlled opex**. We expect OCBC to see the largest net income

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decline of 7% qoq with UOB the smallest at flattish qoq.

Deposit driven balance sheet expansion, an emerging focus to drive earnings

Balance sheet expansion is an important lever for earnings, not only through loan growth but also growth in liabilities via strategic deployment into securities. In the current environment of relatively subdued loan demand, growing liabilities - particularly deposits - enables banks to expand their investment book and generate incremental net interest income. Singapore experienced strong inflows of both deposits and AUM due to its status as a regional wealth and liquidity hub; and we have seen robust banking system deposit growth of +8.7% yoy and +4.1% ytd (or +9.6% yoy and +7.6% ytd adjusting for constant exchange rate), well above historical median level of 5.6%.

Singapore banks are in a sweet spot to capitalise on this inflow; and DBS and OCBC particularly enjoyed robust deposit inflow, achieving +4.2% and +10.0% yoy deposit growth, respectively, focusing on attracting low-cost deposits to bolster NII through investment in higher-yielding assets. In contrast, UOB pursued a more conservative approach prioritizing LDR management. In addition, all 3 banks continued to see decent net new money inflow in the past few quarters, with annualized new inflow equivalent to 6%-8% of AUM. This strong volume growth should help to cushion the NII pressure from falling rates.

Looking at NII performance, DBS leads the way with +4% yoy growth in 1H25, which we attribute to proactive balance sheet management including strong deposit growth and leveraging of debt and interbank securities, and superior repricing execution. UOB delivered flat NII growth, while OCBC saw 4% yoy NII decline, despite a similar balance sheet expansion strategy, due to slower repricing in deposit and in our view likely higher exposure to floating rate loans.

Strong system deposit growth in Singapore on multiple tailwinds

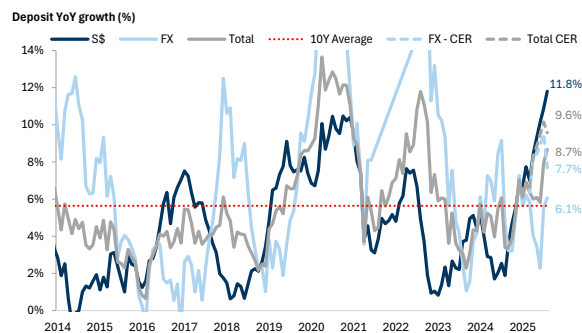
Singapore's banking industry has delivered strong deposit growth in 2025, reaching +8.7% yoy by Aug 2025, a significant improvement from the 2024 average of +4.9%, and the 10-year median of +5.6%. This growth, unusual during rate cut periods, was primarily driven by an **+11.8% yoy/ +7.3% ytd growth in S\$ deposit**. We note that FX deposit slowed to +6.1% yoy/ +1.5% ytd, amidst the sharp appreciation of S\$ in 2025. Assuming that a majority of these FX deposit are denominated in US\$, our estimate indicates that the **FX deposit growth on a constant-currency basis would be solid at 7.7% yoy/ +7.6% ytd**. That said, **the total nominal increase of total deposit in 2025 YTD is already higher than the 2024 increase (Exhibit 3)**. By segments, Residents led the YTD nominal deposit increase with 36%, followed by NBFIs (29%), Singapore government and statutory boards (19%), and non-residents (16%), whose contribution was potentially diluted by S\$ appreciation. By deposit type, CASA grew robustly at +17.6% yoy, while TD declined 1.7% yoy due to falling SORA.

We believe key drivers for the deposit growth include: 1) **Continued capital inflow into Singapore**, evidenced by substantial

foreign direct investment in finance and insurance (60% of Singapore's 2024 FDI) and a surge in family offices (from 400 in 2020 to 2,000 by the end of 2024); 2) **Retail investors' outflow from T-bills**, gauged by the auction amount allotted to non-competitive applications, falling to S\$21.0bn as of Aug from S\$32.0bn in Dec 2024, with this outflow potentially accounting for 14% of notional deposit growth if all were re-deposited. 3) **Strong performance of S\$** against US\$ and other major currencies making S\$ denominated deposits an attractive option.

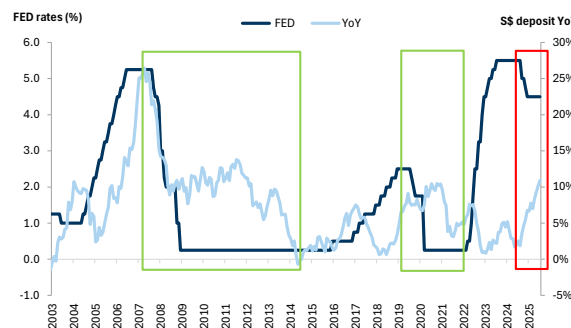
We expect Singapore system deposit growth to moderate to 6.5% in 2026, down from 2025 level but still above the 10-year average of 5.6%. This forecast includes 5.5% in S\$ as we anticipate S\$ deposit nominal growth to return to the average level post covid, driven by expectation of much less S\$ appreciation, as expected by our strategists, and therefore normalization of capital inflow, while partly offset by continued T-bills outflow into deposit. For fx deposits, we expect 7.1% growth, also reflecting an average level of volume growth post covid on constant exchange rate basis, also based on a conservative assumption of more normalized capital inflows.

Exhibit 1: Singapore deposit growth has picked up to above historical level in 2025...



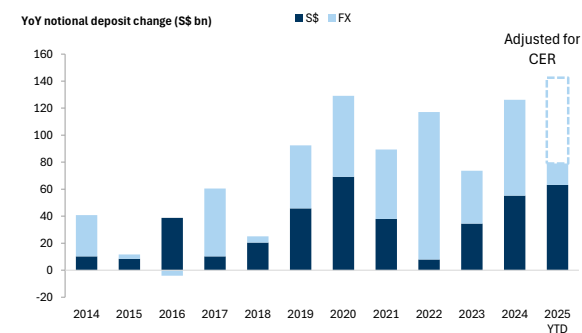
Source: MAS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: ...amidst the Fed rate cuts, which was different from historical rate cut cycles



Source: MAS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

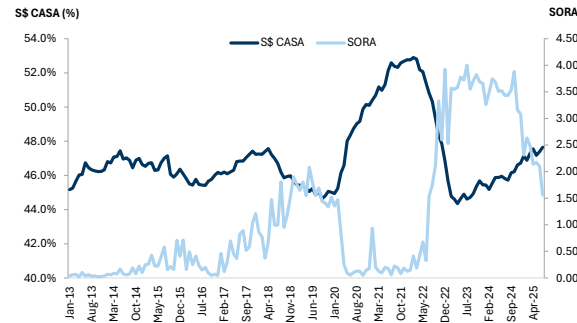
Exhibit 3: 2025 deposit growth was driven by both S\$ and FX, though partly offset by S\$ appreciation



CER for constant exchange rate

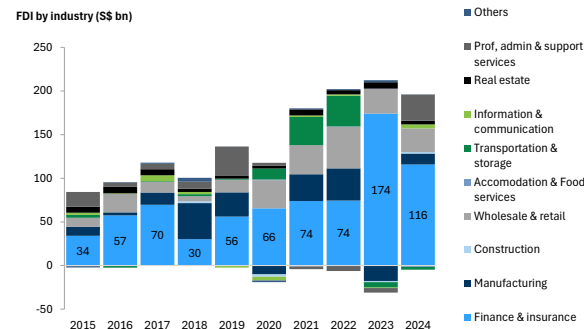
Source: MAS

Exhibit 4: The growth was also driven by an increase in CASA from an account type perspective



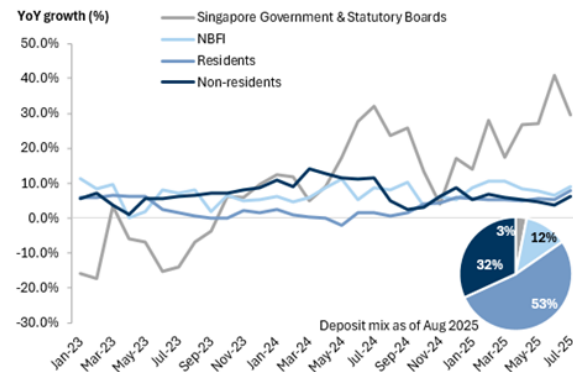
Source: MAS

Exhibit 7: There is significant amount from FDI in finance and insurance



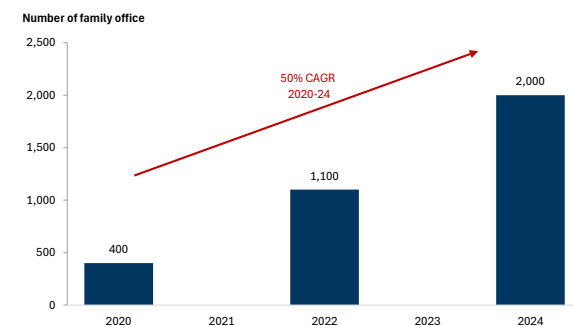
Source: MAS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: By customer type, deposit growth from government and statutory boards picked up..



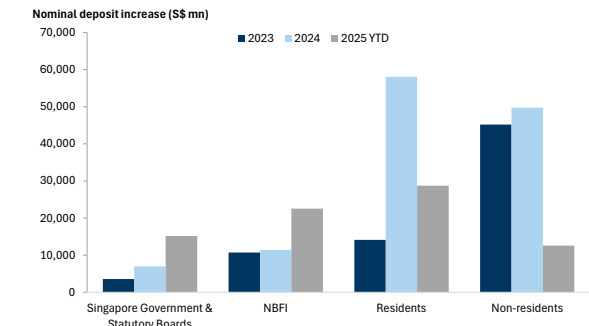
Source: MAS

Exhibit 8: Number of family office in Singapore experienced significant growth



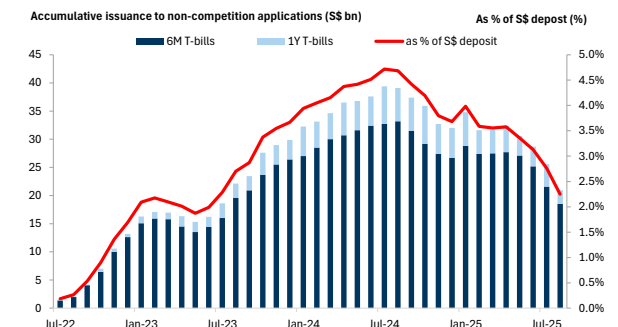
Source: MAS

Exhibit 6: ...while residents remain the largest deposit growth contributor, though we believe non-residents contribution could have been diluted by S\$ appreciation



Source: MAS

Exhibit 9: Decline in non-competitive applications (mostly retail) holding of government securities could have aided deposit growth



Source: MAS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

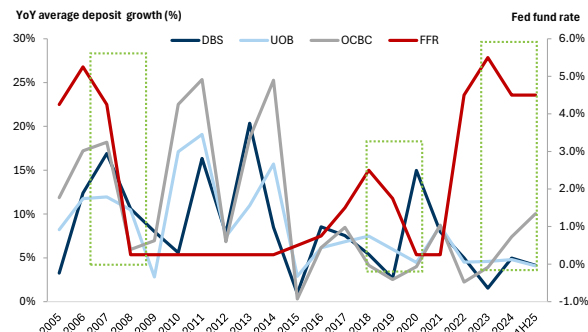
DBS and OCBC lead deposit growth, while UOB holds back

The Singapore banks have delivered decent +2.2% YTD deposit growth by 1H25. Among the 3 Singapore banks, OCBC and DBS are more proactive in collecting deposit, with deposits +4.2%/+2.2% YTD respectively, (+8.2%/+6.7% YTD based on constant exchange rate by our estimate). Notably, OCBC attracted a disproportionate share of US\$ (46% of the increase vs. total deposit mix of 35%). Both banks highlighted a strategic focus on accumulating low-cost deposits and redeploying them

to higher-yielding investment assets, a move to support NII, though dilutive to NIM. In contrast, UOB delivered muted deposit growth at just +0.3% YTD (+3.3% on CER), as the bank prioritized LDR management to support NII. The nominal increase of UOB deposit in 1H25 is only half of its near peer OCBC.

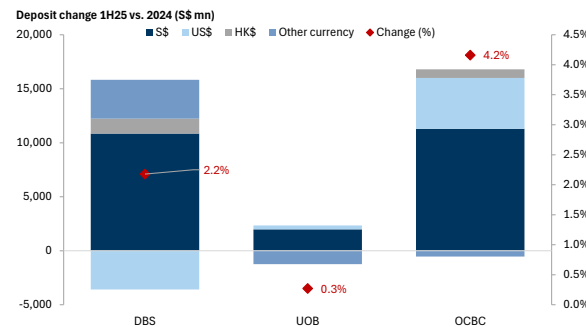
We believe the ability to attract sustained deposits growth is emerging as a key differentiator for profitability in a falling interest rate environment, and the recent momentum at OCBC and DBS positions both banks well.

Exhibit 10: OCBC delivered improving deposit growth in 1H25



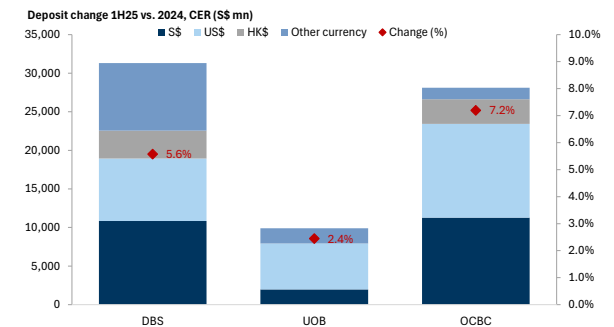
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: OCBC leads deposit growth...



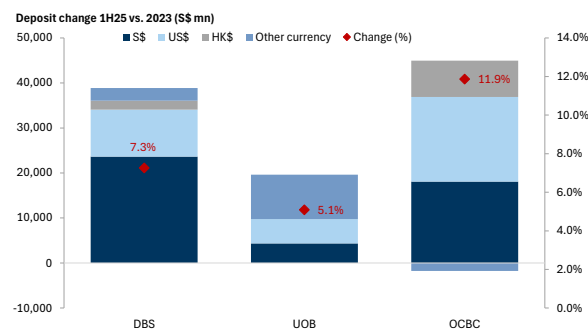
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: ...and after adjustment for CER, YTD deposit growth for the 3 banks have been very robust at 5.6%-7.2% by our estimate



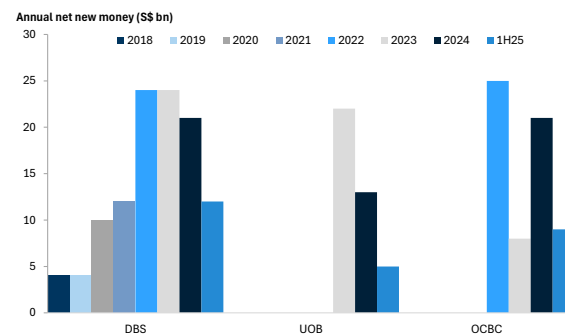
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: OCBC saw more deposit increase from US\$



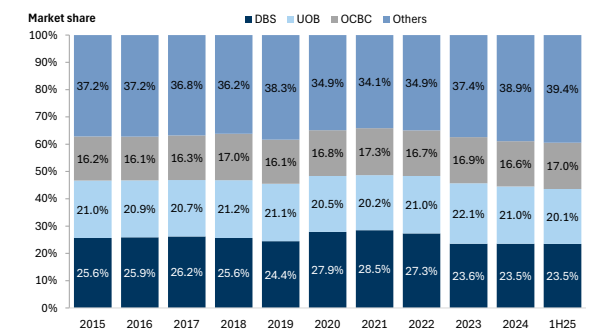
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: Singapore banks have experienced sustained net new money inflow

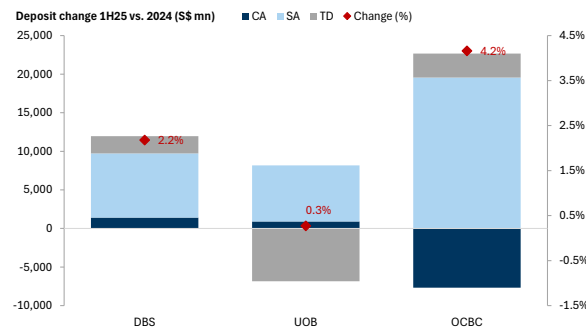


Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

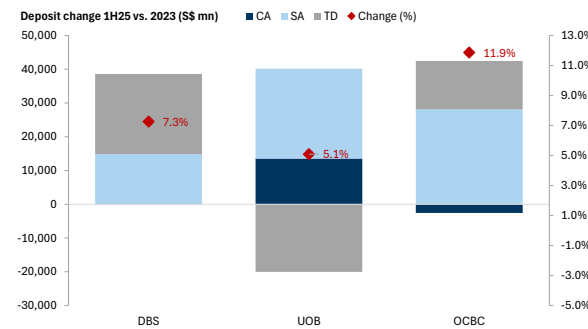
Exhibit 15: OCBC gained market share in S\$ deposits in 1H25



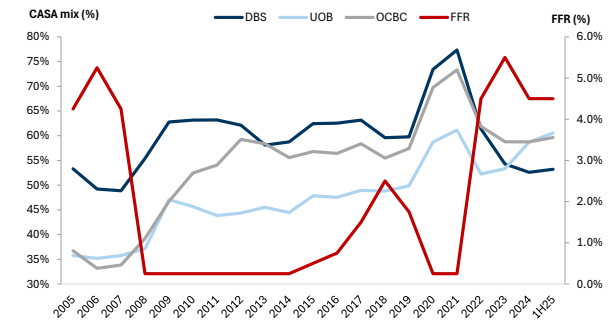
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: All 3 banks experienced strong inflow of SA deposit

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: UOB reduced time deposits to manage LDR

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: CASA ratios have improved to pre-covid level

Source: Company data

Volume growth helps to cushion NII pressure, DBS leads

Volume growth helped Singapore banks to cushion interest income in the falling rate environment. DBS has notably demonstrated leading strength in maintaining its NII trajectory, delivering 4% yoy growth in 1H25 vs. 1H24, ahead of peers. Furthermore, looking through the rate cycle since 1H22, DBS has also notably outperformed peers with 58% NII growth. The performance reflects DBS's solid deposit growth and proactive balance sheet management, including leveraging debt and interbank securities to boost interest earnings assets and deploy excess liquidity into investment assets. Similarly, OCBC deployed a similar balance sheet expansion strategy with growth in both securities and investments, while UOB focused more on loan growth. We note that interest income from investment assets has been a rising contributor to banks interest income ([Exhibit 27](#))

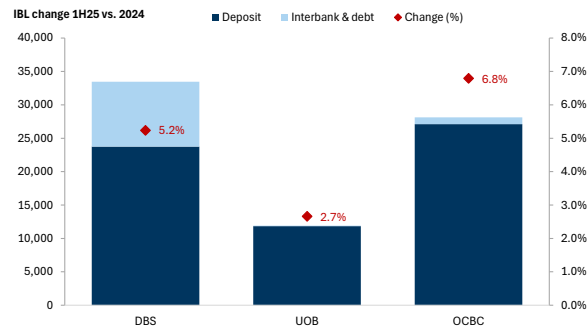
While volume growth is crucial, effective repricing of deposit and loans is also a key differentiator for NII management. While OCBC adopted a similar expansion strategy, its NII performance was weaker at -4% yoy decline at 1H25 due to lagging in deposit repricing execution, and higher impact from loan repricing which we believe is likely due to its larger portion of floating rate loans, which helped in the previous rate hike phase, but became a drag as rates declined.

Exhibit 19: Despite a backdrop of rate cuts, DBS maintained +4% growth in NII via balance sheet growth and effective repricing management

1H25 vs. 1H24				As % if base NII		
NII change driven by	DBS	UOB	OCBC	DBS	UOB	OCBC
Volume	275	124	289	4%	3%	6%
Customer loans	165	441	498	2%	9%	10%
Interbank balances	72	(178)	12	1%	-4%	0%
Securities	566	170	287	8%	4%	6%
Customer deposits	(253)	(208)	(441)	-4%	-4%	-9%
Interbank / others	(275)	(101)	(67)	-4%	-2%	-1%
Rate	(6)	(116)	(501)	0%	-2%	-10%
Customer loans	(1,127)	(1,034)	(1,176)	-16%	-22%	-24%
Interbank balances	(414)	(226)	(324)	-6%	-5%	-7%
Securities	(102)	(2)	(61)	-1%	0%	-1%
Customer deposits	1,396	944	844	20%	20%	17%
Interbank / others	241	202	216	3%	4%	4%
Total	269	8	(212)	4%	0%	-4%

Source: Company data

Exhibit 22: DBS and OCBC delivered higher IBL growth with active management across types of liabilities



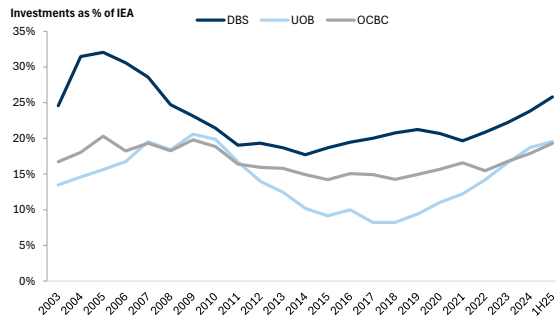
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 20: On the rate hike cycle, OCBC outperformed in NII growth with proactive loan growth and loan repricing

1H23 vs. 1H22				As % if base NII		
NII change driven by	DBS	UOB	OCBC	DBS	UOB	OCBC
Volume	136	69	145	3%	2%	5%
Customer loans	6	(43)	26	0%	-1%	1%
Interbank balances	1	52	100	0%	1%	3%
Securities	140	93	48	3%	3%	1%
Customer deposits	(3)	(38)	(41)	0%	-1%	-1%
Interbank / others	(8)	5	12	0%	0%	0%
Rate	1,927	1,228	1,379	42%	35%	43%
Customer loans	5,071	4,089	3,829	109%	115%	120%
Interbank balances	1,154	1,208	1,188	25%	34%	37%
Securities	1,078	526	491	23%	15%	15%
Customer deposits	(4,154)	(3,705)	(3,684)	-90%	-104%	-115%
Interbank / others	(1,222)	(890)	(445)	-26%	-25%	-14%
Total	2,063	1,297	1,524	44%	37%	48%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 23: On the asset side, banks increased allocation to investment...



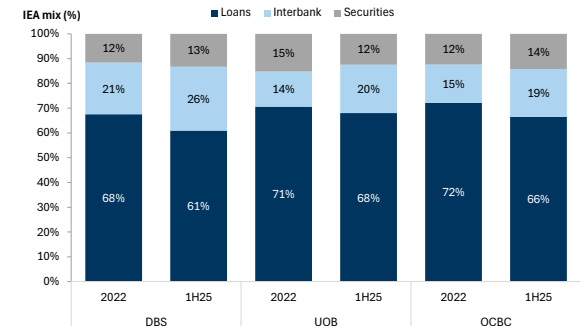
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 21: Over the whole rate cycle, DBS NII outperformed peers with active volume growth and better asset and deposit repricing

1H25 vs. 1H22	Volume and rate analysis			As % if base NII		
NII change driven by	DBS	UOB	OCBC	DBS	UOB	OCBC
Volume	783	234	492	17%	7%	15%
Customer loans	278	496	633	6%	14%	20%
Interbank balances	392	(245)	252	8%	-7%	8%
Securities	956	472	511	21%	13%	16%
Customer deposits	(506)	(389)	(549)	-11%	-11%	-17%
Interbank / others	(337)	(100)	(355)	-7%	-3%	-11%
Rate	1,906	961	934	41%	27%	29%
Customer loans	4,856	3,445	3,235	105%	97%	101%
Interbank balances	814	1,055	909	18%	30%	28%
Securities	1,469	767	708	32%	22%	22%
Customer deposits	(3,929)	(3,483)	(3,547)	-85%	-98%	-111%
Interbank / others	(1,304)	(823)	(371)	-28%	-23%	-12%
Total	2,689	1,195	1,426	58%	34%	45%

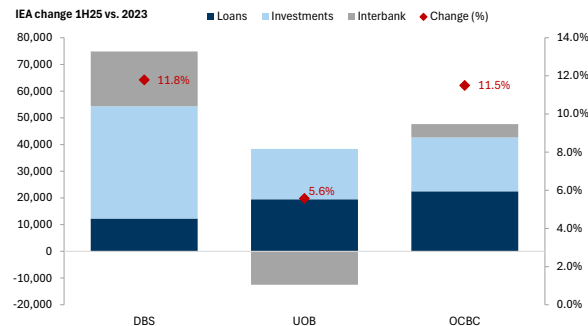
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 24: ...while loan contribution was lowered



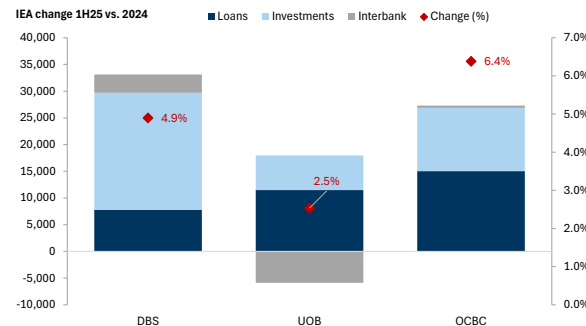
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 25: Within the 3 SG banks, DBS has demonstrated the most active approach in increasing its investment exposure...



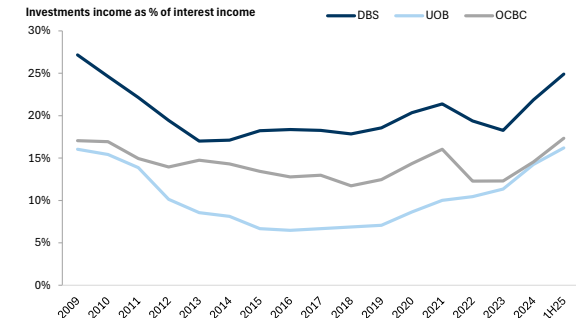
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 26: ...followed by OCBC



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: Interest income from investments has increasingly contributed to total interest income in the past 2 years...



Source: Company data

Earnings driver with high ROEs; banks with strong deposit franchise benefit most

Balance sheet and deposit growth in particular have emerged as a key earnings driver for Singapore bank in an interest rate cutting cycle. While falling interest rates put pressure on banks' earnings, incremental deposit growth deployed into securities, or accompanied by AUM inflows can help offset pressure or even lift NII and fee income. Crucially, these activities carry a low risk weighting, making the strategy highly ROE accretive and scalable given limited capital consumption.

To quantify the impact we map out the earnings dynamic of this strategy. Our analysis shows that a 1ppt increase in deposits could add 0.2%–0.4% of operating income from deploying these excess deposits into securities ("gapping") and 0.6–0.7% additional operating income if deposits were sourced through AUMs. While earnings contribution is low, it is highly ROE accretive given these activities have low risk weights. ROE from gapping in our analysis is around 15%–33%, while from wealth management it is 30%–60%. This allows for scalable growth with limited capital consumption. We also conduct a scenario analysis across the banks to assess earnings and ROE sensitivity under varying assumptions for deposit growth, investment spreads and AUM-related fee income ratios.

With Singapore experiencing strong inflows of both deposits and AUM due to its status as a regional wealth and liquidity hub, we see our covered banks as being in a sweet spot to capitalise on this capital efficient growth opportunity and drive higher ROEs over the medium term. Among the three Singapore banks we see DBS as being set to benefit the most given its robust funding franchise that allows for stronger than peers ability to gather deposits and at a lower cost, resulting in better earnings and ROE accretion. Overall we raise our deposit growth by up to 3ppt for 2025 and 2026 for the banks.

Earnings accretion, though NIM dilutive

We assess the contribution of deposit growth to better understand the earnings dynamics. As shown in [Exhibit 28](#) - where we look at the contribution to operating income from a 1ppt growth in deposits for the 3 Singapore banks - the growth in deposits, even when not deployed into loans, is a positive for earnings when deployed into securities and even more so when accompanied by AUM inflows that generate fee income. That said, we do note that the spreads on these investments is narrow, which will result in NIM compression. Among the three Singapore banks DBS benefits the most from this strategy, supported by its better funding franchise and thus lower funding cost, and if deposits are accompanied by AUM its higher invested AUM ratio and higher yield on invested AUM.

As noted, the Singapore banks are well-positioned to capitalise on this dynamic given strong deposit inflows - driven by Singapore's role as a regional wealth hub, a resilient currency, and its status as a financial safe haven provide ample funding capacity, as noted in the earlier section. While we expect these inflows of deposits into Singapore to moderate slightly, we expect they will remain above historical averages through 2026. Both DBS and OCBC have been more active in leveraging this opportunity and management commentary in recent analyst briefing indicates an intention to continue to do so. Accordingly, we raise our FY 2025-2026 deposit growth assumptions for DBS to 8%/7% from 5%/4% and for OCBC to 9%/7% from 7%/5% respectively and UOB to 4%/6% from 2%/5% as it begins to align more closely with peers.

Exhibit 28: Liability growth a positive to earnings with DBS benefitting more due to its low funding cost.

Analysis of : Earnings upside from balance sheet growth												
	DBS				OCBC				UOB			
Metrics												
NIM (%) - 2026	1.98				1.78				1.77			
Interest Spread (%) - 2026	1.71				1.52				1.56			
1% increase in deposits -2025	6,069				4,243				4,183			
LDR 2025	74.3				77.9				83.4			
Operating Income 2026 (\$mn)	24,309				14,412				14,183			
1% deposit growth	(\$mn)	Yield (%)	Income (\$mn)	% to Op Inc	(\$mn)	Yield (%)	Income (\$mn)	% to Op Inc	(\$mn)	Yield (%)	Income (\$mn)	% to Op Inc
Deployed into Loan and Securities												
Loan	4,508	3.52	158.8		3,307	3.78	125.0		3,489	3.85	134.3	
Investment	1,561	2.60	40.6		936	2.50	23.4		695	2.30	16.0	
Deposit	6,069	1.00	(60.8)		4,243	1.62	(68.9)		4,183	1.55	(64.9)	
Total		2.28	138.6	0.57%		1.87	79.5	0.55%		2.04	85.4	0.60%
Deployed to Securities												
Investment	6,069	2.60	158.0		4,243	2.50	106.0		4,183	2.30	96.3	
Deposit	6,069	1.00	(60.8)		4,243	1.62	(68.9)		4,183	1.55	(64.9)	
Total		1.60	97.2	0.40%		0.87	37.1	0.26%		0.75	31.4	0.22%
Deposits collected from AUM												
Wealth Management Fees	7,724	1.31	100.9		6,365	0.86	54.6		2,789	1.61	45.0	
Interest Earnings Assets (ex AUM)	6,069	1.26	76.5		4,243	1.01	42.9		4,183	1.01	42.2	
Total			177.4	0.73%			97.5	0.68%			87.2	0.61%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Low risk weights amplify ROE and support scalable growth

While the earnings accretion from each incremental 1ppt deposit growth may appear modest in absolute terms as per [Exhibit 28](#), the strategy of balance sheet expansion through “gapping” or via AUM driven growth is highly ROE accretive. This is primarily because these activities carry low risk weights, as such translating limited NII gains into outsized ROE accretions. [Exhibit 29](#) shows the ROEs from gapping in our estimate is anywhere from 15%–33% and ROEs from wealth at 35%–60%. Here, in our dupont analysis for each bank we forecast each bank’s security yield and deposit cost in 2026. For fees on AUM we use fee income generated in 1H2025 as a guide. Cost to asset is GSe CIR of bank in 2026 or CIR of wealth management as guided by bank. RWA for gapping is based on the mix of each bank’s securities in 1H25 with RWA derived from banks’ Pillar 3 disclosure. CET1 is that of each bank’s optimal allocation. ROE of DBS’s WM is per management comments (UOB/OCBC is per our analysis). Among the three Singapore banks, as shown in the exhibit below, banks with stronger deposit franchises and thus access to lower cost deposits (like DBS) are better placed, in our view.

The low risk density of securities portfolios allows banks to expand balance sheets without materially impacting capital ratios. This provides headroom to scale earnings and deliver incremental shareholder returns despite being in an environment of muted loan demand without heavy capital needs. This dynamic enables banks to maintain or grow CET1 while delivering

incremental shareholder returns through higher ROE. Given banks are currently in a sweet spot, with flush and growing system liquidity in Singapore, this strategy provides an attractive capital efficient growth avenue. Aligning liability growth with capital optimization could be a key differentiator for ROE expansion in the medium term, in our view.

Exhibit 29: ROEs range of 20%-60% from gapping or wealth growth given low risk weights (2026E)

	DBS			OCBC				UOB		
	Collected as deposits and placed in		Collected as AUM	Collected as deposits and placed in		Collected as AUM	BOS (2024 financials)	Collected as deposits and placed in		Collected as AUM
	Loans & Securities	Securities		Loans & Securities	Securities			Loans & Securities	Securities	
Loan Yield	3.52%			3.78%				3.85%		
Security Yield	2.60%	2.60%		2.50%	2.50%			2.30%	2.30%	
Deposit cost	1.00%	1.00%		1.62%	1.62%			1.55%	1.55%	
NIM	2.28%	1.60%	1.26%	1.87%	0.87%	1.01%	1.33%	2.04%	0.75%	1.01%
Fees/Asset	0.1%	0.0%	1.7%	0.1%	0.0%	1.3%	1.4%	0.2%	0.0%	1.1%
Cost/Asset	1.0%	0.6%	1.5%	0.8%	0.4%	1.4%	1.7%	1.0%	0.3%	1.1%
Provision/ Asset	0.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.2%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.3%	0.0%	0.0%
Tax Rate	0.2%	0.1%	0.2%	0.1%	0.1%	0.1%	0.1%	0.2%	0.1%	0.2%
ROA	1.1%	0.8%	1.2%	0.8%	0.4%	0.78%	0.9%	0.8%	0.4%	0.82%
Risk Weight	42.2%	18.1%	15.3%	37.1%	13.9%	15.4%	26.0%	49.4%	17.0%	16.3%
RoRWA	2.6%	4.5%	8.1%	2.1%	3.1%	5.1%	3.4%	1.7%	2.1%	5.0%
CET1 (1H25)/ Leverage	15.1%	13.5%	13.5%	15.3%	14.5%	14.5%	18.7%	15.1%	14.0%	14.0%
ROE	17.2%	33.5%	60.0%	13.9%	21.4%	34.9%	14.4%	11.1%	14.8%	35.8%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Scenario analysis: Earnings and ROE accretion potential from deposit and AUM growth

To quantify the potential impact of deposit led balance sheet growth on earnings and returns, we conduct a scenario analysis across the 3 Singapore banks. The analysis models the incremental earnings and ROE uplift under varying assumption of deposit growth, investment yield spreads and wealth-related fee to AUM ratio.

Our analysis shows that for a 4ppt additional deposit growth, average differential of deposit growth and loan growth for 2025/26 for DBS and OCBC which are more active in this strategy, shows operating income accretion of 1.6%/1.0%, respectively if deployed into securities or 2.9%/2.7% uplift if these deposits came from wealth AUM. With this, ROE accretion would be 14bps/5bps and 31bps/14bps, respectively.

Exhibit 30: Earnings and ROE accretion potential from deposit and AUM growth

DBS																	
Operating Income uplift if all is placed in securities									Operating Income uplift if deposits came as AUM								
Spread	Deposit growth								Fees on invested AUM	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	0.71%		1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	
	1.30%	0.3%	0.6%	1.3%	1.9%	2.6%	3.2%	3.9%		0.91%	0.6%	1.2%	2.4%	3.6%	4.8%	6.0%	7.2%
	1.40%	0.3%	0.7%	1.4%	2.1%	2.8%	3.5%	4.2%		1.11%	0.7%	1.3%	2.7%	4.0%	5.3%	6.7%	8.0%
	1.50%	0.4%	0.7%	1.5%	2.2%	3.0%	3.7%	4.5%		1.31%	0.73%	1.5%	2.9%	4.4%	5.8%	7.3%	8.8%
	1.60%	0.4%	0.8%	1.6%	2.4%	3.2%	4.0%	4.8%		1.51%	0.8%	1.6%	3.2%	4.8%	6.3%	7.9%	9.5%
	1.70%	0.4%	0.8%	1.7%	2.5%	3.4%	4.2%	5.1%		1.71%	0.9%	1.7%	3.4%	5.1%	6.9%	8.6%	10.3%
	1.80%	0.4%	0.9%	1.8%	2.7%	3.6%	4.5%	5.4%		1.91%	0.92%	1.8%	3.7%	5.5%	7.4%	9.2%	11.0%
	1.90%	0.5%	0.9%	1.9%	2.8%	3.8%	4.7%	5.7%									

ROE uplift if all is placed in securities								
Spread	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	
	1.30%	2bps	4bps	9bps	13bps	17bps	21bps	25bps
	1.40%	3bps	5bps	10bps	16bps	21bps	26bps	31bps
	1.50%	3bps	6bps	12bps	18bps	24bps	30bps	36bps
	1.60%	4bps	7bps	14bps	21bps	28bps	34bps	41bps
	1.70%	4bps	8bps	16bps	24bps	31bps	39bps	46bps
	1.80%	4bps	9bps	18bps	26bps	35bps	43bps	52bps
	1.90%	5bps	10bps	19bps	29bps	38bps	48bps	57bps

ROE uplift if deposits came as AUM								
AUM Fees on Assets	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	
	1.06%	3bps	7bps	13bps	20bps	26bps	33bps	39bps
	1.26%	5bps	10bps	19bps	29bps	38bps	47bps	57bps
	1.46%	6bps	13bps	25bps	38bps	50bps	62bps	74bps
	1.66%	8bps	16bps	31bps	46bps	62bps	77bps	92bps
	1.86%	9bps	19bps	37bps	55bps	74bps	92bps	110bps
	2.06%	11bps	22bps	43bps	64bps	85bps	106bps	127bps
	2.26%	12bps	25bps	49bps	73bps	97bps	121bps	145bps

OCBC																	
Operating Income uplift if all is placed in securities									Operating Income uplift if deposits came as AUM								
Spread	Deposit growth								Fees on invested AUM	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	1.0%		2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%		
	0.57%	0.2%	0.3%	0.7%	1.0%	1.4%	1.7%	2.0%		0.26%	0.4%	0.8%	1.6%	2.5%	3.3%	4.1%	4.9%
	0.67%	0.2%	0.4%	0.8%	1.2%	1.6%	2.0%	2.4%		0.46%	0.5%	1.0%	2.0%	3.0%	4.0%	5.0%	6.0%
	0.77%	0.2%	0.5%	0.9%	1.4%	1.8%	2.3%	2.7%		0.66%	0.6%	1.2%	2.4%	3.5%	4.7%	5.9%	7.1%
	0.87%	0.3%	0.5%	1.0%	1.5%	2.1%	2.6%	3.1%		0.86%	0.68%	1.4%	2.7%	4.1%	5.4%	6.8%	8.1%
	0.97%	0.3%	0.6%	1.1%	1.7%	2.3%	2.9%	3.4%		1.06%	0.8%	1.5%	3.1%	4.6%	6.1%	7.6%	9.2%
	1.07%	0.3%	0.6%	1.3%	1.9%	2.5%	3.2%	3.8%		1.26%	0.9%	1.7%	3.4%	5.1%	6.8%	8.5%	10.2%
	1.17%	0.3%	0.7%	1.4%	2.1%	2.8%	3.5%	4.1%		1.46%	0.94%	1.9%	3.8%	5.6%	7.5%	9.4%	11.3%

ROE uplift if all is placed in securities									
Spread	Deposit growth								
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%		
	0.57%	0bps	1bps	1bps	2bps	2bps	3bps	4bps	
	0.67%	1bps	1bps	3bps	3bps	4bps	5bps	6bps	
	0.77%	1bps	2bps	4bps	6bps	8bps	10bps	12bps	
	0.87%	1bps	3bps	5bps	8bps	11bps	13bps	16bps	
	0.97%	2bps	3bps	7bps	10bps	13bps	17bps	20bps	
	1.07%	2bps	4bps	8bps	12bps	16bps	20bps	24bps	
	1.17%	2bps	5bps	10bps	14bps	19bps	24bps	28bps	

ROE uplift if deposits came as AUM								
		Deposit growth						
		1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%
AUM Fees on Assets	0.69%	0bps	0bps	0bps	0bps	0bps	0bps	0bps
	0.89%	1bps	2bps	5bps	7bps	10bps	12bps	14bps
	1.09%	2bps	5bps	10bps	14bps	19bps	24bps	28bps
	1.29%	4bps	7bps	14bps	21bps	29bps	36bps	43bps
	1.49%	5bps	10bps	19bps	29bps	38bps	47bps	57bps
	1.69%	6bps	12bps	24bps	36bps	48bps	59bps	71bps
	1.89%	7bps	14bps	29bps	43bps	57bps	71bps	85bps

UOB																	
Operating Income uplift if all is placed in securities									Operating Income uplift if deposits came as AUM								
Spread	Deposit growth								Fees on Invested AUM	Deposit growth							
		1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%			1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%
	0.45%	0.1%	0.3%	0.5%	0.8%	1.1%	1.3%	1.6%		1.01%	0.5%	1.0%	2.0%	3.0%	4.0%	5.0%	6.0%
	0.55%	0.2%	0.3%	0.7%	1.0%	1.3%	1.6%	2.0%		1.21%	0.5%	1.1%	2.1%	3.2%	4.3%	5.4%	6.4%
	0.65%	0.2%	0.4%	0.8%	1.2%	1.5%	1.9%	2.3%		1.41%	0.6%	1.2%	2.3%	3.5%	4.6%	5.8%	6.9%
	0.75%	0.2%	0.4%	0.9%	1.3%	1.8%	2.2%	2.7%		1.61%	0.61%	1.2%	2.5%	3.7%	4.9%	6.1%	7.4%
	0.85%	0.3%	0.5%	1.0%	1.5%	2.0%	2.5%	3.0%		1.81%	0.7%	1.3%	2.6%	3.9%	5.2%	6.5%	7.9%
	0.95%	0.3%	0.6%	1.1%	1.7%	2.2%	2.8%	3.4%		2.01%	0.7%	1.4%	2.8%	4.2%	5.5%	6.9%	8.3%
	1.05%	0.3%	0.6%	1.2%	1.9%	2.5%	3.1%	3.7%		2.21%	0.73%	1.5%	2.9%	4.4%	5.9%	7.3%	8.8%

ROE uplift if all is placed in securities								
Spread	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	
	0.45%	-1bps	-1bps	-3bps	-4bps	-5bps	-6bps	-7bps
	0.55%	0bps	0bps	-1bps	-1bps	-2bps	-2bps	-3bps
	0.65%	0bps	0bps	1bps	1bps	1bps	2bps	2bps
	0.75%	1bps	1bps	2bps	3bps	5bps	6bps	7bps
	0.85%	1bps	2bps	4bps	6bps	8bps	10bps	12bps
	0.95%	1bps	3bps	6bps	8bps	11bps	14bps	16bps
	1.05%	2bps	4bps	7bps	11bps	14bps	18bps	21bps

ROE uplift if deposits came as AUM								
AUM Fees on Assets	Deposit growth							
	1.0%	2.0%	4.0%	6.0%	8.0%	10.0%	12.0%	
	0.48%	0bps	1bps	2bps	2bps	3bps	4bps	5bps
	0.68%	2bps	4bps	7bps	11bps	14bps	18bps	21bps
	0.88%	3bps	6bps	13bps	19bps	26bps	32bps	38bps
	1.08%	5bps	9bps	19bps	28bps	37bps	46bps	55bps
	1.28%	6bps	12bps	24bps	36bps	48bps	60bps	72bps
	1.48%	8bps	15bps	30bps	45bps	59bps	74bps	88bps
	1.68%	9bps	18bps	36bps	53bps	71bps	88bps	105bps

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

3Q25 preview: A slightly weaker quarter given NIM pressures

Singapore banks will be reporting their 3Q25 financials starting with DBS and UOB both on Nov 6th, followed by OCBC on Nov 7th. For 3Q, we expect earnings to decline by -4% qoq, and ROE to taper to 13.2% on average mainly due to a: **1) Sharp decline in NIMs in 3Q of -10 to -11bps qoq**, reflecting the continued falls in SORA, though partly offset by stabilization of HIBOR; **2) higher qoq credit cost**, DBS and OCBC at the higher end of the banks' guidance range vs below guidance cost of

credit in 2Q, while UOB above guidance, reflecting our conservative stance on provisioning. These headwinds are expected to be partially offset by: **3) Higher qoq Non-NII** mainly due to robust investment sentiment during the quarter, and continued wealth inflow; **4) well-controlled opex**. We expect OCBC to see the largest qoq core net income decline of -7% qoq with UOB the smallest at flattish qoq.

- **DBS:** We forecast 3Q25 net profit of S\$2,657mn (-6% qoq/-12% yoy). On a qoq basis. The primary driver for the qoq decline in bottom line was a 11bps qoq decline in NIM to 1.94%, flattish from Jul exit NIM of 1.95%. The compression largely reflects the impact of continued decline in SORA (-60bps qoq), though it was partly offset by the stabilization in HIBOR. Partially offsetting this margin compression was a stronger non-NII performance, which increase +3.7% qoq, driven by the wealth business on the back of improved market sentiment. We anticipate stable performance across other operating lines, with loan growth of +1% qoq/+5% yoy, well-controlled opex growth of +4% qoq. Furthermore, we expect stable asset quality and incorporated a credit cost forecast of 19bps, at the higher end of the guidance range of 17-20bps.
- **OCBC:** We forecast 3Q25 net profit of S\$1,693mn (-7% qoq/-14% yoy). Similar to DBS, we anticipate that lower NIM will be the primary factor dragging down net profit. We expect NIM to decline by 11bps qoq, down 7bps from Jun exit NIM of 1.88%, mainly driven by the decrease in SORA rates while partly offset by the rebound of 1M HIBOR. Furthermore, we project a qoq increase in opex, as we expect CIR to normalize to guidance level of low 40s, up from the 39% realized in 1H25. Our credit cost forecast is 25bps, higher than 14bps realized in 2Q25 and at the higher end of the company's guidance of 20-25bps, as we maintain a conservative stance on provisioning. On the positive side, we expect a qoq increase in non-NII, with growth across fee income driven by sustained strong AUM momentum and improving investment sentiment, and other non-NII due to favorable capital market.
- **UOB:** We forecast 3Q net profit of S\$1,334mn (-0% qoq/ -17% yoy), due to lower NII and higher credit cost. NII is expected to decline 5% qoq due to 10bps qoq decline in NIM, down 3bps from Jun exit NIM of 1.84%, due to lower SORA but offset by cuts to their expensive CASA deposit rates. We forecast credit cost of 37bps, higher than guidance of 25-30bps for FY and the 33bps realized in 2Q25, reflecting our conservative stance, especially on the CRE portfolio. We expect this to be partly offset by decent fee income and other non-NII growth, and operating expenses are expected to be well-controlled at -1% qoq and -5% yoy.

Exhibit 31: Singapore banks' results preview

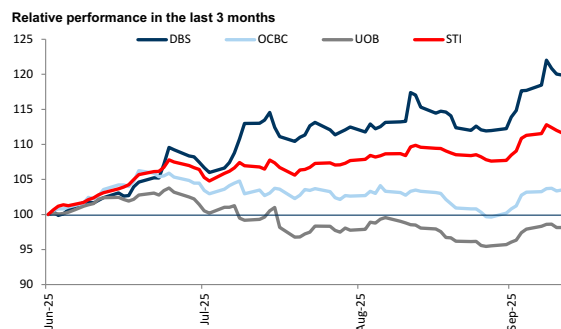
S\$mn	DBS					OCBC					UOB				
	3Q25E	2Q25	QoQ (%)	3Q24	YoY (%)	3Q25E	2Q25	QoQ (%)	3Q24	YoY (%)	3Q25E	2Q25	QoQ (%)	3Q24	YoY (%)
NII	3,472	3,648	(4.8)	3,597	(3.5)	2,190	2,283	(4.1)	2,433	(10.0)	2,218	2,336	(5.0)	2,460	(9.8)
Fee Income	1,231	1,167	5.5	1,109	11.0	592	580	2.0	508	16.5	687	636	8.0	630	9.0
Other Non-NII	930	917	1.4	1,047	(11.2)	692	684	1.2	861	(19.6)	527	493	6.8	744	(29.2)
Non- NII	2,161	2,084	3.7	2,156	0.2	1,284	1,264	1.6	1,369	(6.2)	1,213	1,129	7.5	1,374	(11.7)
Operating Expenses	(2,352)	(2,270)	3.6	(2,249)	4.6	(1,478)	(1,389)	6.4	(1,463)	1.0	(1,518)	(1,536)	(1.1)	(1,590)	(4.5)
PPOP	3,281	3,462	(5.2)	3,504	(6.4)	1,997	2,158	(7.5)	2,339	(14.6)	1,913	1,929	(0.8)	2,244	(14.7)
Impairment charges	(210)	(133)	57.9	(130)	61.5	(207)	(114)	81.5	(169)	22.5	(320)	(279)	14.7	(304)	5.2
Pre-tax Profit	3,144	3,388	(7.2)	3,440	(8.6)	2,038	2,301	(11.4)	2,415	(15.6)	1,614	1,638	(1.5)	1,923	(16.1)
Net Profit	2,657	2,824	(5.9)	3,027	(12.2)	1,693	1,816	(6.8)	1,974	(14.2)	1,334	1,338	(0.3)	1,610	(17.1)
Core Net Profit	2,657	2,824	(5.9)	3,027	(12.2)	1,693	1,816	(6.8)	1,974	(14.2)	1,334	1,338	(0.3)	1,638	(18.5)
Reported NIM (%)	1.94	2.05	-11bp	2.11	-17bp	1.81	1.92	-11bp	2.18	-37bp	1.81	1.91	-10bp	2.05	-24bp
Credit Costs (bps)	19	12	7bp	12	7bp	25	14	11bp	22	3bp	37	33	5bp	37	0bp
Cost-to-income Ratio	42	40	2pp	39	3pp	43	39	3pp	38	4pp	44	44	0pp	41	3pp
Gross Loans	444,936	439,100	1.3	424,000	4.9	327,648	324,606	0.9	305,000	7.4	345,880	342,900	0.9	333,998	3.6
ROA (%)	1.25	1.34	-9bp	1.53	-28bp	1.04	1.13	-9bp	1.32	-27bp	0.98	0.96	2bp	1.23	-25bp
ROE (%)	15.7	16.9	-120bp	19.0	-328bp	11.7	12.4	-70bp	14.2	-252bp	11.2	10.7	52bp	14.4	-318bp

Note: Net profit is before the payment of dividends on preference shares

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

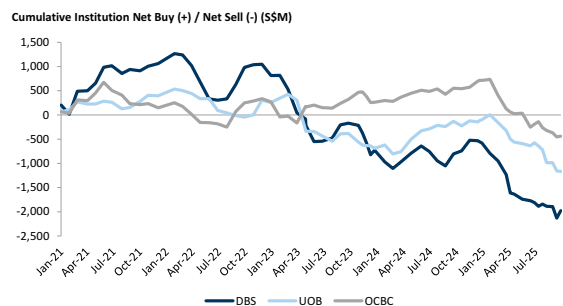
3Q25 in six charts

Exhibit 32: DBS outperformed STI while UOB and OCBC underperformed in 3Q25



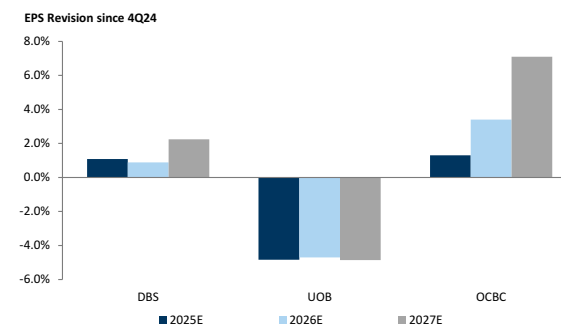
Source: Thomson Reuters, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 33: All three banks saw outflows from institutional investors in 3Q25



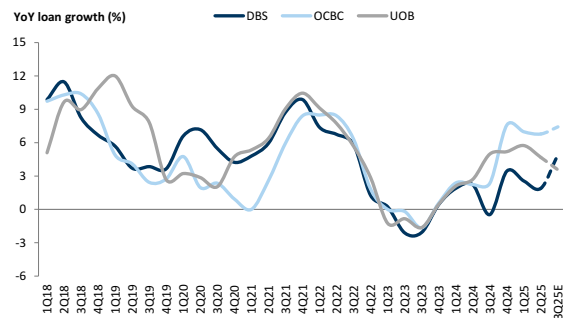
Source: SGX, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 34: Consensus EPS have been revised up for DBS and OCBC while down for UOB



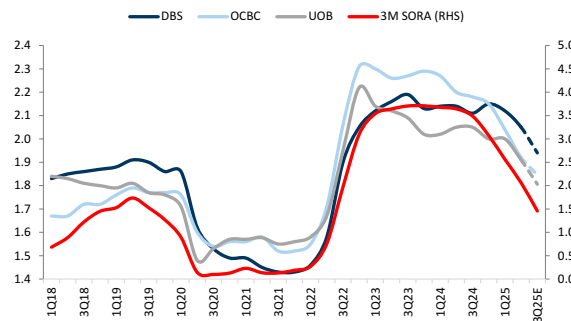
Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 35: We anticipate credit growth to remain at mid single-digit levels for the Singapore banks in 3Q25, with OCBC and DBS showing the sequential improvement



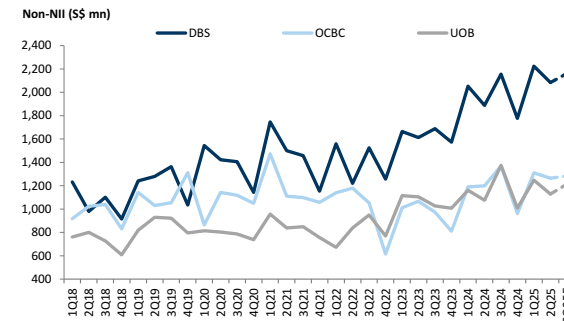
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 36: NIMs to trend lower in 3Q25 given the continued decline in SORA



Source: MAS, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 37: We estimate non-NII to remain strong supported by wealth activity



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

EPS and TP changes

For our Singapore banks coverage, we revise up 2025-27E EPS by 0-7% for DBS and OCBC, mainly driven by higher NIMs to bake in the HIBOR rebound and higher NII as we revise up deposit growth forecast. For UOB, we revise down 2025-27E forecast by 2%-3%, as we revise down our NIM forecast due to declining SORA. Our two-stage DDM valuation methodology is unchanged. Our target prices for the three banks have been updated by -1% to +10% accordingly, incorporating revised earnings forecasts.

Exhibit 38: EPS changes

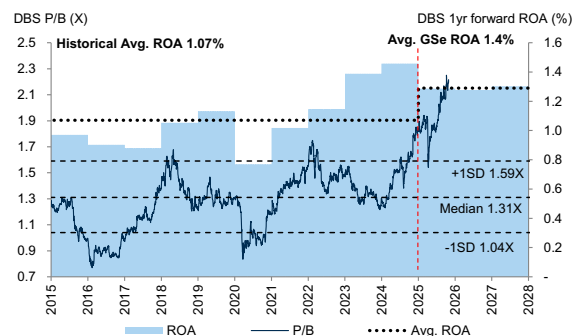
Company	New EPS estimates (\$)			Old EPS estimates			Earnings change		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
DBS	3.82	4.19	4.48	3.81	3.94	4.18	0.3%	6.4%	7.3%
OCBC	1.54	1.60	1.73	1.52	1.58	1.67	1.3%	1.8%	3.1%
UOB	3.22	3.43	3.68	3.28	3.52	3.78	-1.7%	-2.7%	-2.6%
Singapore	2.86	3.07	3.30	2.87	3.01	3.21	0.0%	1.8%	2.6%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

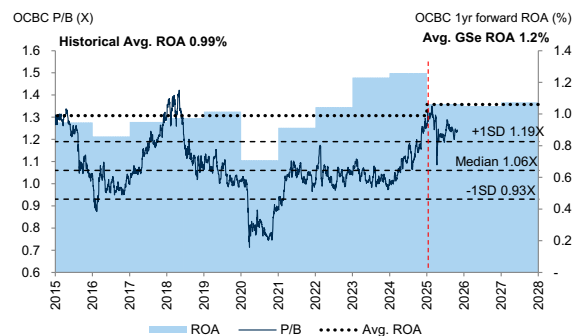
Exhibit 39: 12-month Target price changes

Company name	Upside/ downside to 12m TP	Total return	Current Price (Local Crcy) as of 28-Oct	12-m Target Price (Local Currency)			Rating	Key Risks
				New	Old	Change		
DBS	16%	22%	54.1	62.9	57.2	10%	Buy	(-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition.
OCBC	24%	30%	16.9	21.0	20.0	5%	Buy	(-) Sudden or sharper than expected FED cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.
UOB	20%	26%	34.9	42.1	42.7	-1%	Buy	(-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Poor execution of growth strategy in Citi franchise; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

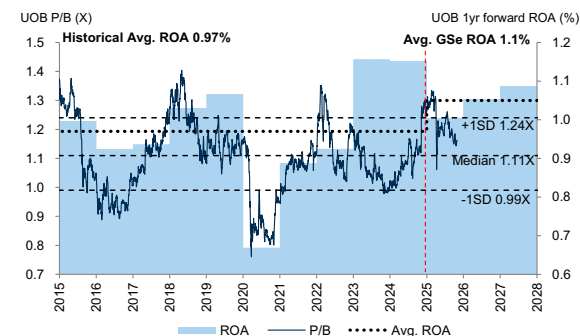
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation**Exhibit 40: DBS is trading at more than 1 std dev above its historical 10-year P/B median...**

Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 41: ...while OCBC is trading 1 std dev above its historical 10-year P/B median...

Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 42: ...and UOB is trading between its historical 10-year P/B median and 1 st dev above

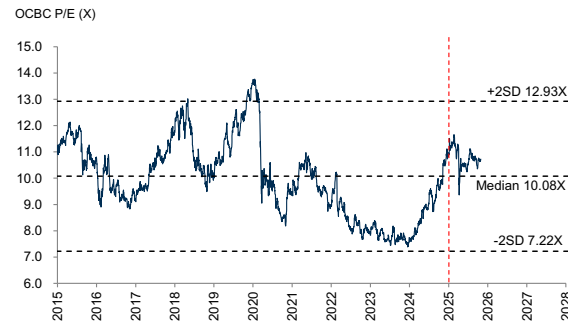
Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 43: On a P/E basis, DBS is trading more than 2 std dev above its historical 10-year median...



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 44: ...while OCBC...



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 45: ...and UOB are trading close to their historical 10-year median



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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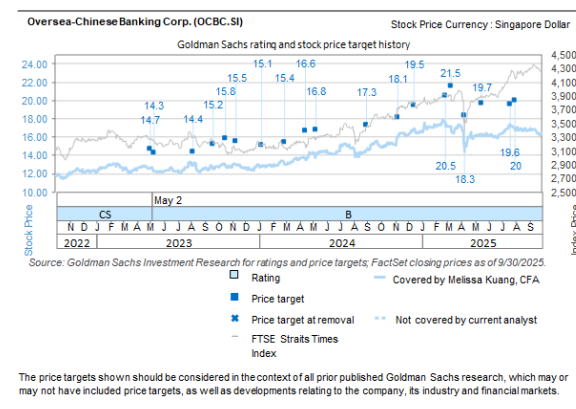
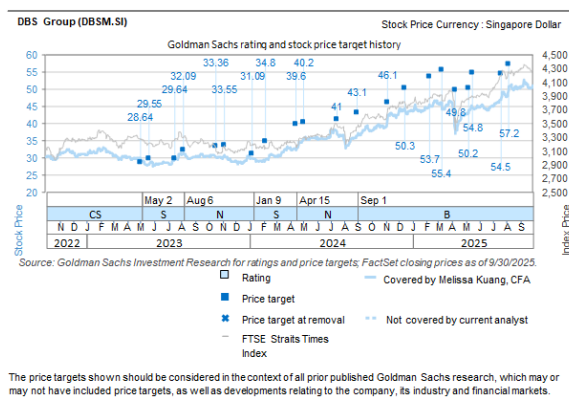
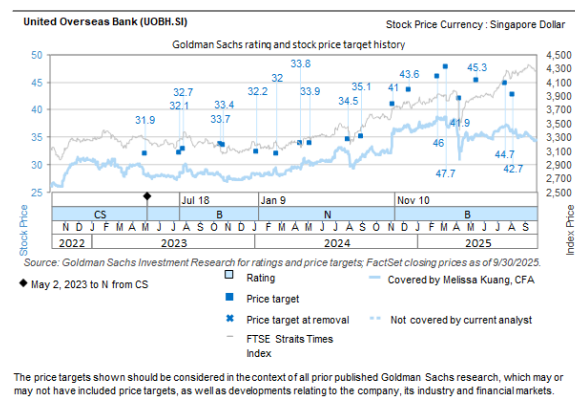
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